

THE DAILY FINANCE BRIEF

Financial News in Plain English

Friday, July 17, 2026

Edition No. 7

Personalised for Rishabh Srinivasan

ECONOMY

Federal Reserve Chair Says No Tolerance for High Inflation

On July 14, 2026, Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh stated that the central bank will not accept high inflation, which is the general rise in prices of goods and services over time. This announcement comes as inflation remains above the Federal Reserve's target of 2%. Warsh's comments indicate that the Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates) is serious about ad-

ressing inflation, which can affect everyday costs for consumers.

While he did not provide specific plans for future actions, the statement reflects a divided opinion among Federal Reserve members about whether to raise interest rates, which are the costs of borrowing money. Higher interest rates can help lower inflation but may also slow down economic growth.

Source: KSL.com

MARKETS

S&P 500 Index Rises as Tech Stocks Perform Well

On July 2, 2026, the S&P 500 Index, which tracks the stock prices of 500 large U.S. companies, closed at 7,483.23, reflecting a 1.7% increase from the previous day. This rise was mainly due to strong performances from technology companies, particularly in artificial intelligence (AI) and semiconductor sectors. The Nasdaq Composite, another index that focuses on tech stocks, also saw a significant increase.

Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh spoke at an important financial forum, reiterating the Fed's commitment to controlling inflation, which can affect the economy and everyday consumers. This news can influence market confidence and investment decisions.

Source: alphaarvion

JPMorgan and Others Invest in New Cryptocurrencies

On July 17, 2026, major financial firms like JPMorgan, BlackRock, and Goldman Sachs announced their investments in alternative cryptocurrencies, known as altcoins. These include popular digital currencies like Ethereum (ETH) and Chainlink (LINK). This news comes as the Depository Trust & Clearing Corporation (DTCC) launched a new system for trading tokenized stocks, which are digital representations of shares in a company.

The involvement of large financial institutions in altcoins can lead to increased interest and volatility in the cryptocurrency market, which can affect everyday investors and consumers.

Source: Blockchain.News

Federal Reserve's Logan Calls for Higher Interest Rates to Combat Inflation

On July 16, 2026, Lorie Logan, the President of the Dallas Federal Reserve, suggested that interest rates should be increased to help manage persistent inflation. Inflation is the rise in prices of goods and services, and Logan believes that it has been too high for too long. This statement indicates that the Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates) is considering actions to stabilize prices, which can directly impact consumers.

Logan's comments highlight the ongoing debate within the Federal Reserve about the best way to address inflation. Raising interest rates can help control inflation but may also slow down economic growth, affecting jobs and spending.

Source: *Investing.com*

COMPANIES

ASML Reports Strong Earnings Thanks to AI Demand

On July 15, 2026, ASML, a company that produces advanced machinery for making computer chips, reported strong earnings for the second quarter of 2026. The company earned €9.33 billion in revenue and €2.92 billion in profit, exceeding expectations. This success is attributed to increased demand for computer chips driven by advancements in artificial intelligence (AI) technology.

ASML's strong performance is a positive sign for the technology sector and may influence job growth and investment in related industries.

Source: *Kiplinger*

Netflix to Release Earnings Report Amid Competition

On July 16, 2026, Netflix is set to announce its earnings for the second quarter of 2026. Analysts are paying close attention to how many new subscribers the company has gained, especially with increased competition from World Cup-related content. Despite some analysts lowering their target price for Netflix stock, they still maintain a Buy rating, highlighting Netflix's efforts to expand into live content as a potential growth area.

The outcome of this earnings report could influence Netflix's stock price and its ability to attract and retain subscribers, which is important for its overall success.

Source: *Kiplinger*

Understanding the CLARITY Act: A New Cryptocurrency Regulation Proposal

The CLARITY Act is a proposed law aimed at creating clear rules for cryptocurrency platforms in the United States. It seeks to address issues that arose during the collapse of FTX, a major cryptocurrency exchange, by establishing standards for protecting customer assets and preventing fraud. This act is in the news today because Congress is advancing the bill, which could lead to better consumer protection in the cryptocurrency market.

If passed, the CLARITY Act could help ensure that consumers have clearer information and protections when dealing with cryptocurrencies, which are digital currencies that use cryptography for security.

Source: *The Crypto Times*

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